

Netflix Content Strategy Research: Regional Distribution and Genre Analysis

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Executive Summary

This research project explores trends in Netflix’s content catalog in selected Asia Pacific markets, specifically South East Asia, Australia/New Zealand, and Taiwan/Hong Kong. Using publicly available data from TMDB, the study investigates how Netflix’s regional distribution strategy has evolved over time and identifies which genres are most widely distributed across these markets.

Key findings include:

1. Netflix content is increasingly multi-region, indicating a strategic shift away from highly localized licensing toward broader regional distribution.
2. Certain genres, such as Soap and War & Politics, are more widely distributed, reflecting strong cross-market scalability, while genres like Drama and Comedy remain largely localized.

1. Introduction

Netflix has become a dominant player in streaming media globally, and understanding its content strategy can provide insight into how streaming platforms balance localization, audience engagement, and production efficiency. This project investigates Netflix’s content strategy in selected Asia–Pacific markets by analyzing catalog metadata, including title type, genre, release year, and regional availability.

The primary objectives of this research are:

- To examine how Netflix's regional distribution strategy has evolved over time.
- To identify which genres are most widely distributed across markets.

This research is based on publicly available data and does not represent Netflix's internal strategic decisions.

2. Methodology

Data Source

The dataset is sourced from the TMDb API and includes publicly available Netflix catalog metadata, such as:

- Title type (Movie or TV Show)
- Genres
- Release year
- Regional availability
- Date added estimates

Data was restricted to the following Asia Pacific markets:

South East Asia: ID, MY, PH, SG, TH

Australia/New Zealand: AU, NZ

East Asia: TW, HK

Data Preparation

- Regional coverage was measured by the number of countries in which a title was available.
- Genre-level analysis involved splitting titles with multiple genres into individual rows to allow per-genre aggregation.
- Distribution strategy was analyzed using counts and proportions of single-region versus multi-region titles over time.

Analysis Approach

- **Descriptive analysis:** Trends in single-region vs multi-region content over time.
- **Comparative analysis:** Median number of regions per title by genre to determine cross-market scalability.

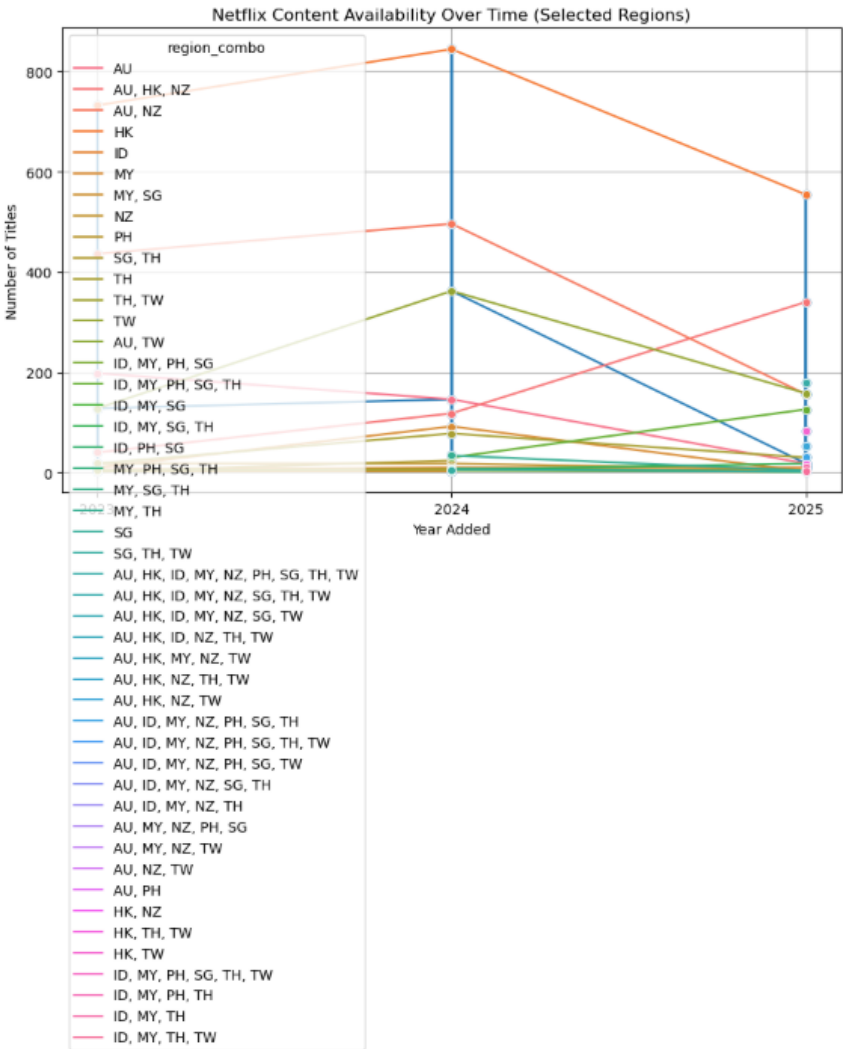
- **Visualization:** Line plots and horizontal bar charts were used to illustrate trends and distribution patterns.

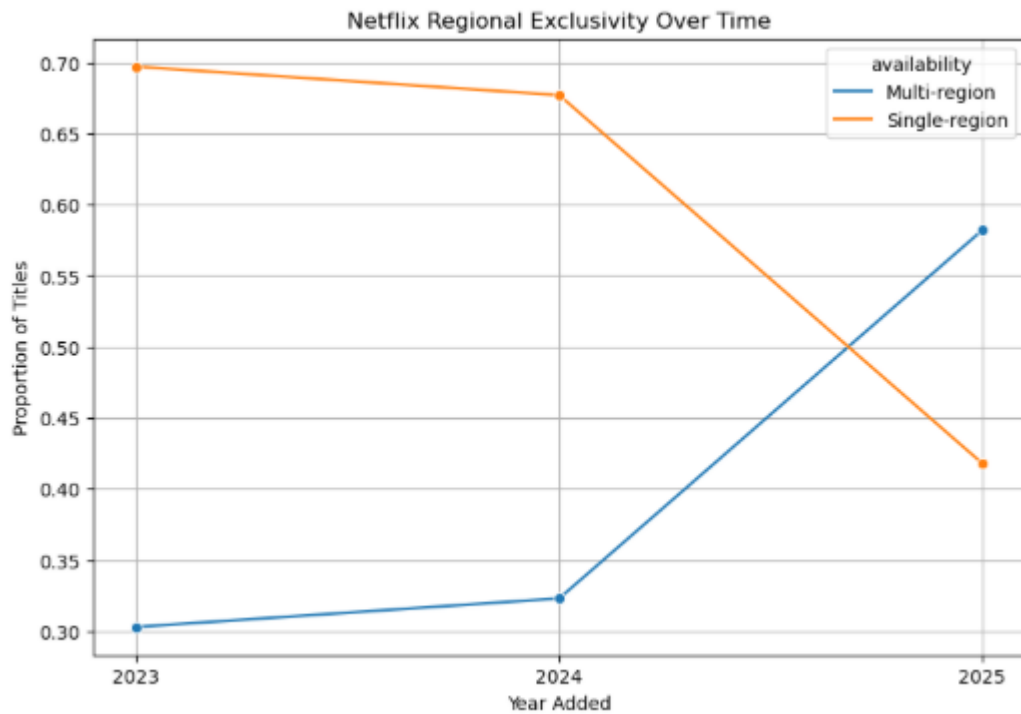
3. Research Question 1: Evolution of Netflix’s Regional Distribution Strategy

Question: How has Netflix’s regional distribution strategy evolved over time, regardless of content type?

Findings

Analysis of single-region versus multi-region titles reveals a clear trend:





- **Single-region titles are decreasing**, while **multi-region titles are increasing** over the 2023–2025 period.
- This suggests Netflix is moving away from highly localized content toward broader cross-regional availability, a pattern indicative of **regional consolidation**.

Interpretation:

- Multi-region availability likely reflects **lower per-market licensing costs**, economies of scale in production, and a “produce once, distribute widely” approach.
- This strategy also signals **maturation of Asia Pacific markets**, with Netflix leveraging regional hubs to reach multiple countries simultaneously.
- However, this pattern reflects **catalog availability rather than audience demand**, as viewership data was not included.

Conclusion:

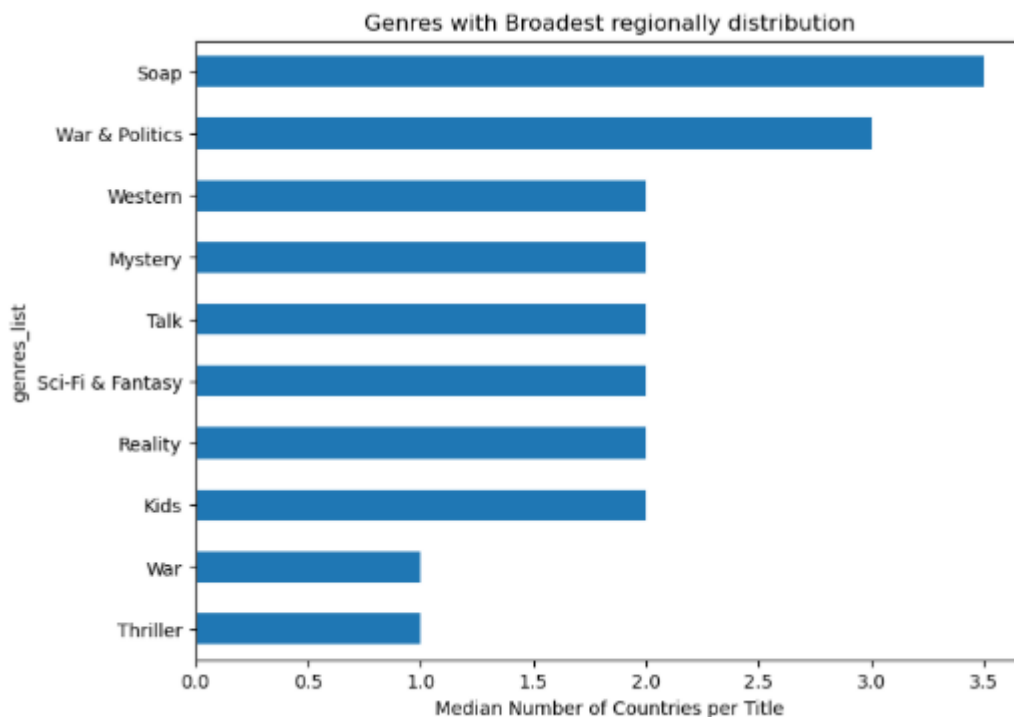
The decline in single-region titles alongside growth in multi-region availability indicates a strategic shift in Netflix’s Asia–Pacific distribution. Netflix appears to prioritize content that can be deployed across multiple markets, optimizing efficiency while reaching broader audiences.

4. Research Question 2: Which Genres Are Most Regionally Distributed?

Question: Which genres appear most widely distributed across Netflix's Asia Pacific markets?

Findings

Using median number of regions per title as a proxy for regional distribution:



- **Most widely distributed genres:**
 - *Soap*: median ≈ 3.5 regions per title
 - *War & Politics*: median ≈ 3 regions per title
- **Moderately distributed genres:**
 - Mystery, Sci-Fi & Fantasy, Reality, Kids, Talk shows (median ≈ 2 regions)
- **Highly localized genres:**
 - Drama, Comedy, Romance, Crime, Documentary, Horror (median = 1 region)

Interpretation

- **Globally scalable genres** (Soap, War & Politics) are distributed across multiple markets due to cross-cultural resonance and universal themes. Soap-style serialized content supports long-term engagement, while War & Politics titles often address universal historical or political narratives.

- **Mid-tier genres** (Mystery, Sci-Fi & Fantasy, etc.) travel to some regions but face barriers such as language, cultural specificity, or audience preferences.
- **Localized genres** (Drama, Comedy, Romance) remain concentrated in single markets, reflecting cultural specificity, local humor, and regional licensing constraints.

Strategic Implication:

Netflix appears to combine regionally scalable content with highly localized genres, balancing **cost efficiency** and **market-specific engagement**. The widest distributed genres are often associated with Netflix Originals, which are produced for multi-region release.

Caveats

- Median regional coverage may be influenced by smaller sample sizes for certain genres.
- Only a subset of the catalog (50-page limit per content type) was analyzed.

5. Conclusion

This analysis demonstrates that Netflix's Asia Pacific content strategy combines **regional scalability and localized content production**:

- Multi-region content is increasing, reflecting strategic consolidation.
- Genre-level patterns show that globally appealing genres are widely distributed, while culturally specific genres remain localized.
- These trends are consistent with Netflix's Originals-driven strategy and broader platform growth objectives.

6. Limitations

- Dataset is limited to publicly available TMDB metadata.
- Regional availability reflects catalog presence, not actual audience engagement.
- Analysis is constrained to selected markets.
- Only 50 pages per content type were used, potentially biasing median calculations for low-volume genres.

8. Future Work

- Extend analysis to include additional regions (Europe, Americas) for global comparison.
- Incorporate audience metrics to assess the impact of regional availability.